

UPPER BACK PAIN

TIPS & STRETCHES TO HELP YOU FEEL BETTER



Upper back pain is common and usually gets better with time and consistent care. Use these tips and stretches to support your recovery.



KEEP MOVING

Stay active and avoid long periods of sitting. Take short walks and change positions throughout the day.



STRETCH DAILY

Gentle stretching can reduce tension and improve flexibility. Do the stretches below 1–2 times per day.



USE HEAT OR ICE

Try ice for the first 24–48 hours, then switch to heat. Use for 15–20 minutes at a time.



MIND YOUR POSTURE

Sit and stand tall with shoulders relaxed. Avoid slouching and position screens at eye level.



LIFT SMART

Bend at your knees, not your waist. Avoid heavy lifting and twisting.



SLEEP WELL

Sleep on your side or back with good support. Use a pillow that keeps your neck aligned.



BE PATIENT & CONSISTENT

Recovery takes time. Small, consistent steps can make a big difference.

WHEN TO SEEK CARE

Seek medical attention if you experience:

- Numbness, tingling, or weakness in your arms or hands
- Pain that gets worse or does not improve
- Fever, unexplained weight loss, or severe pain after an injury

GENTLE STRETCHES FOR UPPER BACK PAIN

1 CAT-COW



CAT



COW

- Start on your hands and knees, wrists under shoulders, knees under hips.
- Inhale, arch your back and lift your head (Cow).
- Exhale, round your back and tuck your chin (Cat).
- Repeat 8–10 times.

2 OPEN BOOK



- Lie on your side with knees bent and arms in front of you.
- Keep hips and knees stacked.
- Open your top arm and rotate your chest up toward the ceiling.
- Hold for 20–30 seconds.
- Repeat 2–3 times each side.

3 THORACIC EXTENSION OVER FOAM ROLLER



- Place a foam roller across your upper back.
- Support your head with your hands.
- Gently extend over the roller by opening your chest.
- Hold for 20–30 seconds.
- Repeat 2–3 times.

4 CHILD'S POSE WITH SIDE REACH



- Kneel on the floor and sit back on your heels.
- Reach one arm out to the side and walk your hand forward.
- Hold for 20–30 seconds.
- Repeat on the other side.
- Repeat 2–3 times each side.



Listen to your body. These stretches should not cause sharp pain. Stop if you feel increased pain and consult a healthcare provider.

IF YOUR SYMPTOMS PERSIST OR WORSEN, PLEASE FOLLOW UP WITH YOUR PROVIDER.

This handout is for educational purposes only and is not a substitute for professional medical advice. Always consult your healthcare provider with any questions or concerns.